

Worksheet 103 · Skills S3.2 · Analysing non-fictional texts

Questions on the text — your scaffold

One routine for every factual text. Fill in the gaps while we work on the Baxter text (book p. 230).

0 Know the task — the operator tells you what to do

I Comprehension	describe, outline, sum up	What does the text say?
II Analysis	analyse, examine, explain	How does it say it — and why?
III Evaluation	comment, discuss, assess	What do you think — and why?

1 Step 1 · Preparation

- a Read the **questions** first, mark the operators.
- b **Skim**: headline, lead, first and last paragraph.
- c **Read** the whole text, mark key words.
- d **Purpose**: text type, source, date, target group.
- e **Understand**: 3–6 words per section in the margin.

Baxter, Helsinki's huge VR gig ...

Topic	<u>virtual concert in Helsinki; future of VR tourism</u>
Text type	<u>feature article with personal report</u>
Target group	<u>general readers, not tech experts</u>
Purpose	<u>to inform and to entertain</u>

Connect: How does the target group explain the way Baxter writes?

She writes for non-experts, so she uses a personal story and explains technical terms.

2 Step 2 · Writing

2a Introductory sentence (first answer only)

In the [text type] "[title]", published in [source] in [date], [author] [reporting verb] [topic].

In her feature article "Helsinki's huge VR gig and the potential of virtual tourism", published in The Guardian online in 2020, Sarah Baxter reports on a virtual concert and explores the future of virtual tourism.

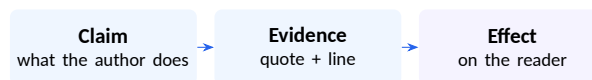
2b Comprehension (I)

- only what is asked
- own words + line references
- present tense, no opinion

Our extra rule:

Pick up the question in the first sentence.

2c Analysis (II)



Thesis → one paragraph per aspect → conclusion

Our model paragraph (Baxter: respect for Helsinki's achievements) — mark C, E, E:

(C) Baxter expresses respect for Helsinki's achievements through appreciative vocabulary. (E) Although she admits that the gig lacked "the buzz of being at a 'proper' concert" (ll. 11–12), she stresses that "technically, it was impressive" (ll. 12–13). (E) Because she first concedes a weakness, her praise sounds balanced and credible, so readers are more likely to share her positive view.

3 From device to effect — collect your own examples

Name the device *and* what it does in *this* text. A list of devices without effect earns little.

Device	Quote (line)	Effect on the reader
personal anecdote	<i>"giant pineapple" (l. 5)</i>	<i>makes VR concrete and funny</i>
expert quotes	<i>Dr Timothy Jung (ll. 61–66)</i>	<i>authority, a credible outlook</i>
short sentence	<i>"It worked." (l. 30)</i>	<i>emphasis on the success</i>

4 Step 3 · Editing and checking

- | | |
|--|--|
| ☐ I did exactly what the operator asks. | ☐ present tense, no contractions |
| ☐ Every statement has a line reference. | ☐ linking words show my line of thought |
| ☐ Quotes are exact and marked "...". | ☐ precise verbs instead of says |
| ☐ My opinion only where asked (III). | ☐ no repetition |

5 Language you need**Reporting verbs**

states · claims · argues · points out · emphasises · criticises · warns

Linking words

furthermore · however · consequently · for instance · all in all

Quoting

(l. 5) · (ll. 5–7) · paraphrase: (cf. l. 5) · omissions [...]

My phrase bank: three phrases I want to use in my next answer

Effect phrases

... emphasises / underlines ... · ... creates the impression that ... · ... makes the reader feel ...

Tone

neutral · enthusiastic · sceptical · ironic · emotive · urgent

Online: step-by-step course, more phrases and the writing coach: edu-mrh.de → **Englisch** → **Klasse 13** → **Questions on the Text**